



**MEMPHIS IS READY
TO ROCK AND ROLL**

The Mid-South Delta will lead innovative agriculture value-chain development by leveraging our ideal growing conditions, abundant natural resources, local expertise, industrial assets, and world-class distribution.





The Region.

16M arable acres

Access to water

Public R1 University

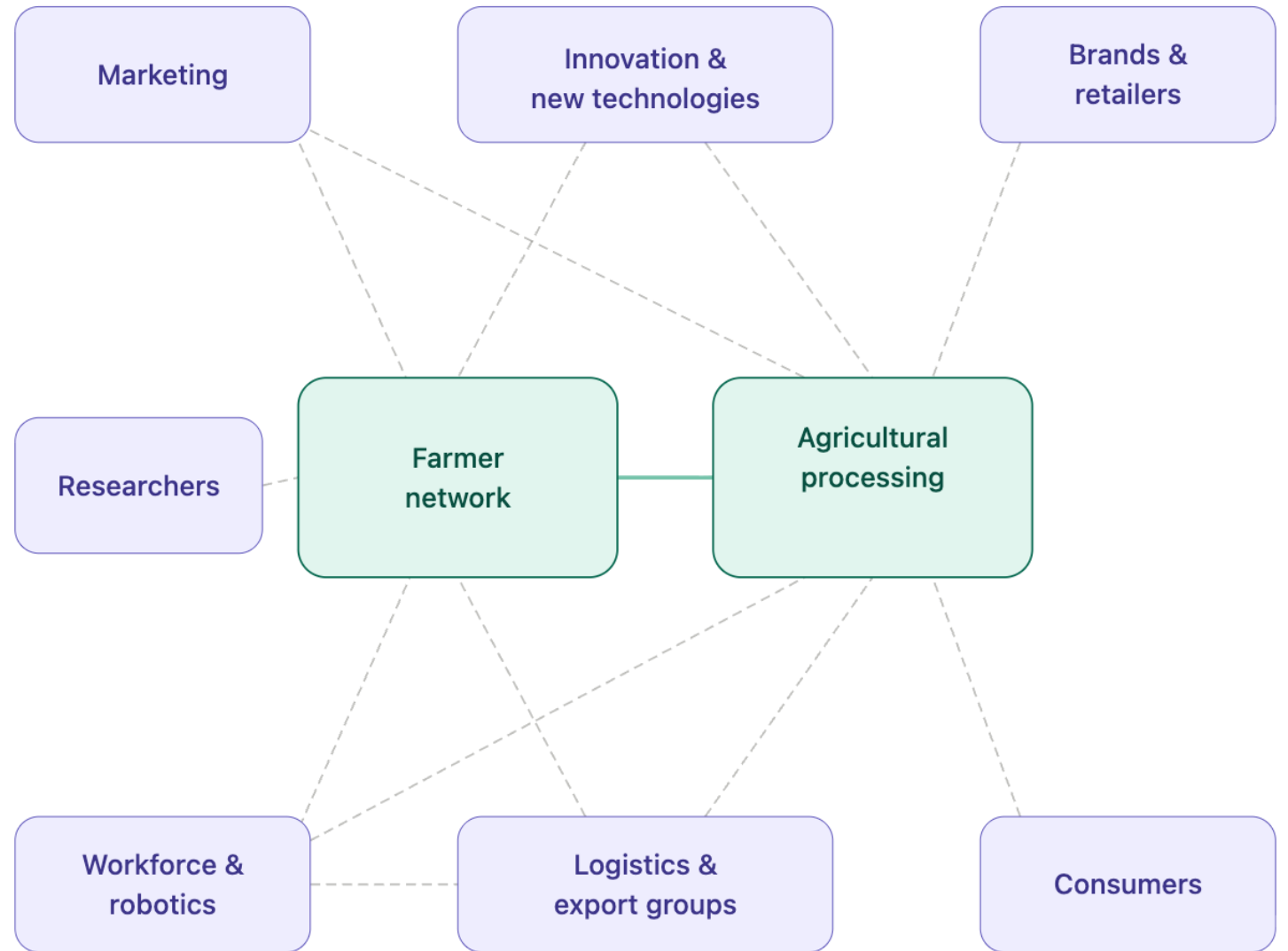
Regional research farms

World class logistics

250 Food & Beverage Companies

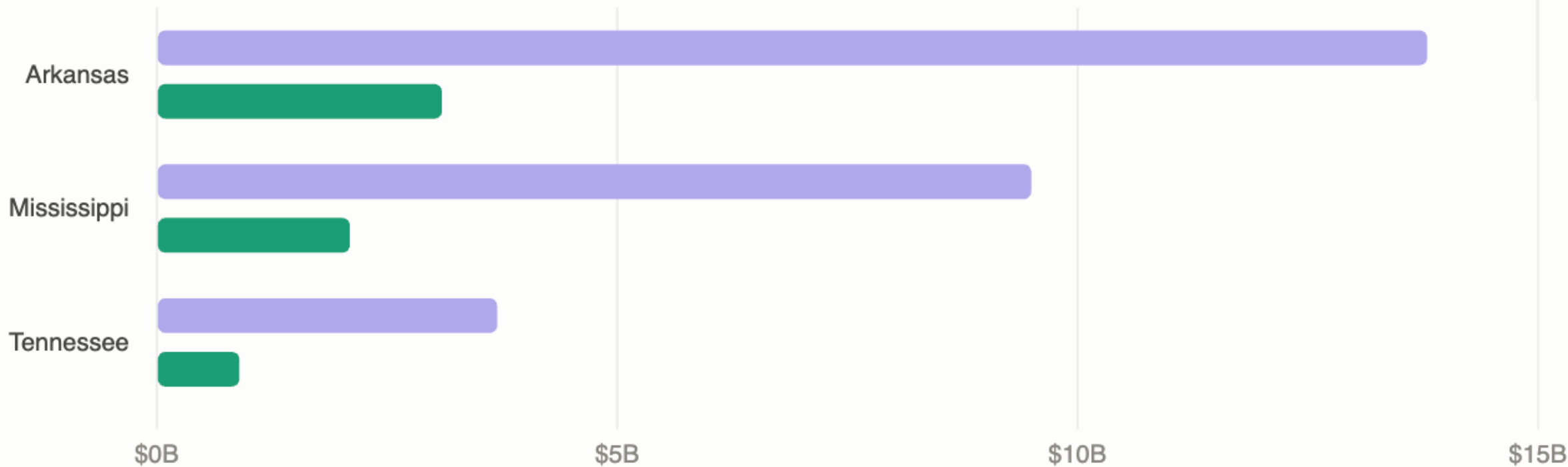
Strategic Priority for our Cluster

Establish a framework to
efficiently assess
agronomic and market
opportunities for new
crops and products



FARM RECEIPTS VS. VALUE RETAINED IN-STATE

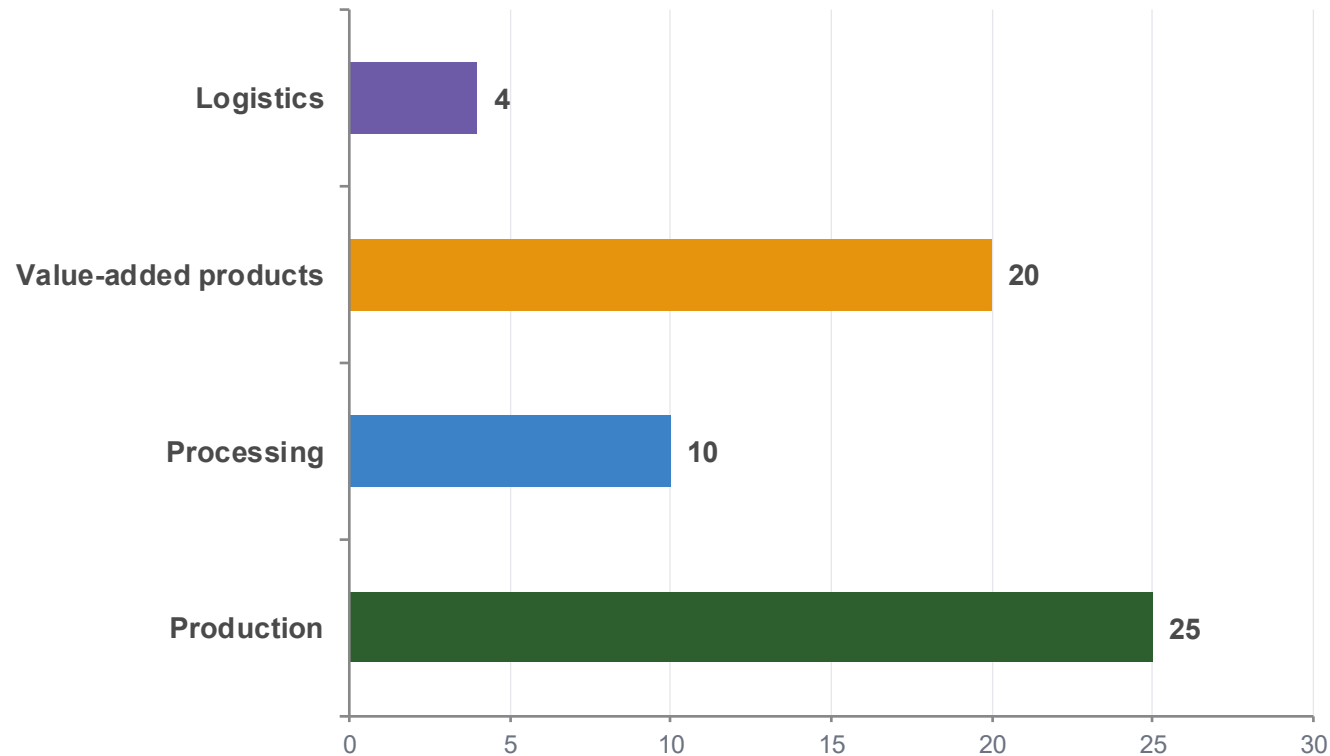
■ Total farm receipts / ag industry value ■ Est. value-added retained in-state



The gap between raw grain and isolate represents ~8× more value per ton: margin that currently accrues to processors outside the region.

Jobs created per ton: specialty tomatoes

Labor hours per ton of raw production | Small-to-mid scale, hand-harvested fresh market



The multiplier effect

Farm gate only

25

hrs / ton



Full value chain

59

hrs / ton

2.4x

more jobs
with local
processing



Production: 25 hrs



Processing: 10 hrs

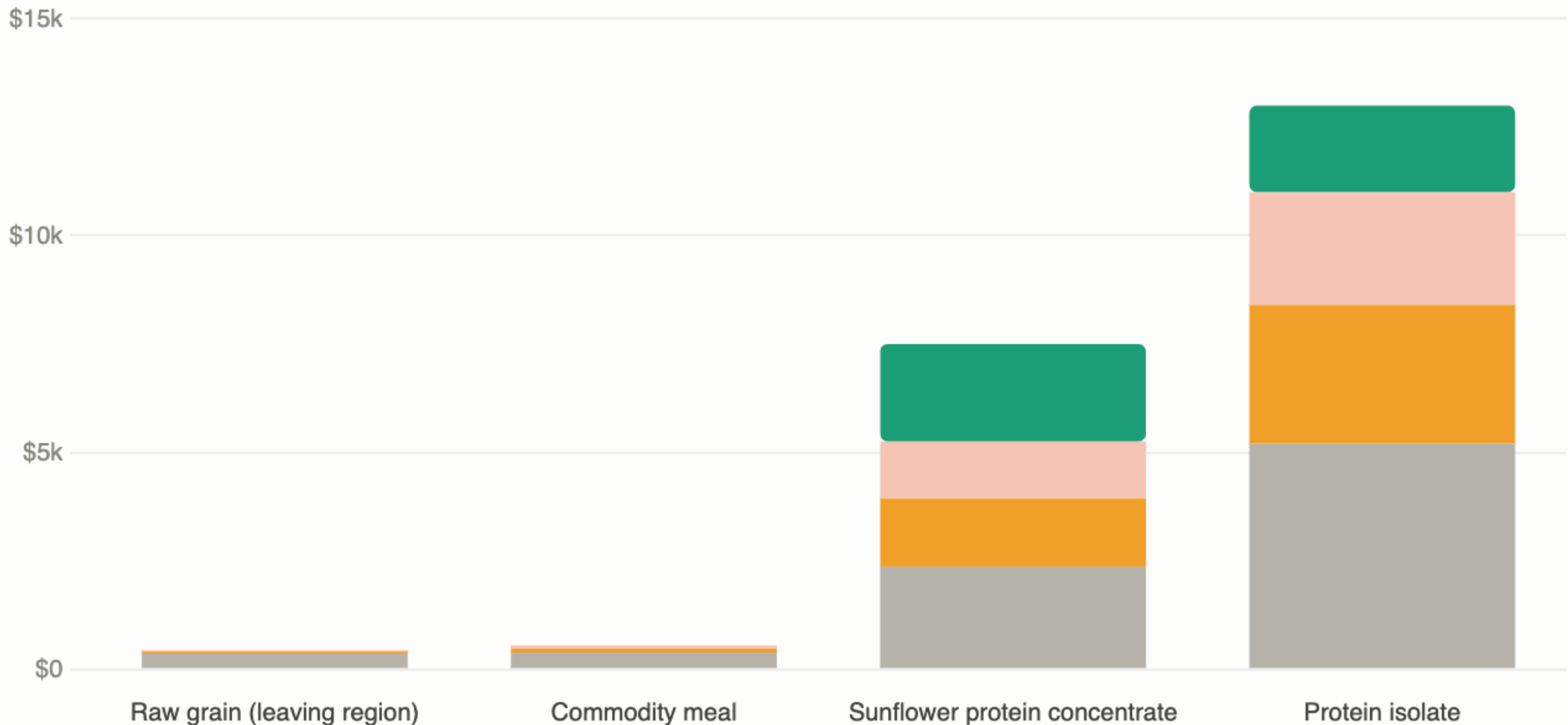
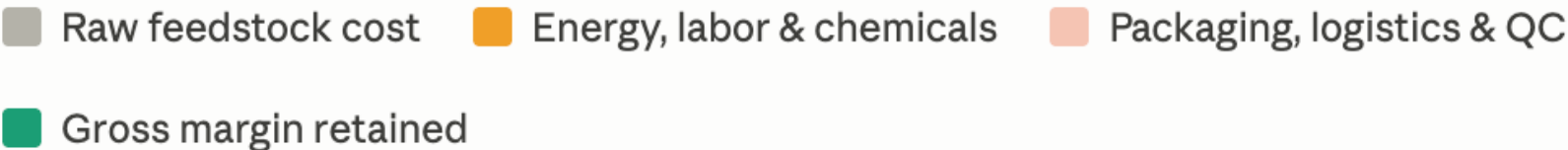


Value-added: 20 hrs



Logistics: 4 hrs

VALUE PER TON: SALE PRICE, COGS, AND GROSS MARGIN BY PROCESSING STAGE



Why this priority: Memphis is ready to rock and roll

- Anchors already working on these initiatives
 - Stress test -> sunflower, garlic, tomato
- We have the agricultural infrastructure, but we are not retaining the value in the region
- Cross-sector collaboration
- Coordinated effort that builds a strong ecosystem





How will we get there?

12-month plan

- Identify an individual to lead
- Identify anchor institutions including farmers
- Identify food & beverage sourcing needs
- Inventory industrial assets
- Enhance on-farm research capacity

90-day activation agenda

- Launch new crop opportunity assessment tool, AgLaunch
- Explore a host institution for the new cluster, MDD
- Identify funding sources to establish the new cluster organization, The Cluster
- Establish a follow-up cadence, The Cluster

Cluster Metrics

Size of the cluster; new partners

Employment in the cluster; direct and indirect

New and activated processing and production facilities

New research projects

New opportunities evaluated

% Acres converted by 2031



It's a slam dunk.